

Classroom SEL pack, a week on patience, ages 3 to 7

Becoming a Tree

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Grow a bean	Put a damp paper towel inside a clear cup and slide a bean between the towel and the cup so you can see it. Keep it damp. Check every day and draw what you see: the root …	Page 8
Day 5 Be the seed	Be the seed, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Problem Solving and Innovating, Belonging and Contributing

Materials

The book (or the class screen), bean seeds, clear cups, paper towels or soil, a watering can, a measuring strip

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What do you think this story is about? How do trees start? Ask: What is something you have to wait for? Is waiting easy or hard? Take a few answers. Teach the worm's words with a gesture: fold your hands, then slowly lift them like a growing plant. 'Good things take time.'

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
2	Oakie lies in the dark soil.	What has Oakie never seen or felt?	the light, the wind
4	Oakie pushes, but the soil is too heavy.	How do you think Oakie felt when he pushed and pushed and nothing happened?	frustrated, sad, impatient
6	'Good things take time.'	What does the worm mean?	you have to wait, keep trying, you will grow
7	Plip-plop! Shine-shine! Months go by.	What does a seed need to grow?	rain, sun, warm soil, time
8	A root goes down and a shoot goes up.	Which way does the root grow? Which way does the shoot grow?	root down, shoot up
10	A deer nibbles a leaf.	How does Oakie feel now?	scared, worried, not safe
11	'Life in the light is worth the risk.'	Why did Oakie decide to keep growing after the deer nibbled his leaf?	he wanted the light, he was brave
15	Oakie gives the little seed the worm's advice.	What did Oakie tell the little seed?	be patient, good things take time

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Patience is not sitting still and being quiet. Oakie keeps trying the whole time. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

seed

a tiny thing that a plant grows from

Do it: pinch your fingers into a tiny dot

soil

the earth that plants grow in

Do it: rub your fingers together like crumbly dirt

root

the part of a plant that grows down into the ground

Do it: wiggle your fingers downward

sprout

a new little plant pushing up

Do it: push one hand slowly up through the other

patient

able to wait calmly

Do it: fold your hands and breathe

Good things take time.

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Be patient. Good things take time, but they’re worth it.

Good things take time.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



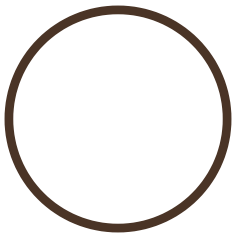
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



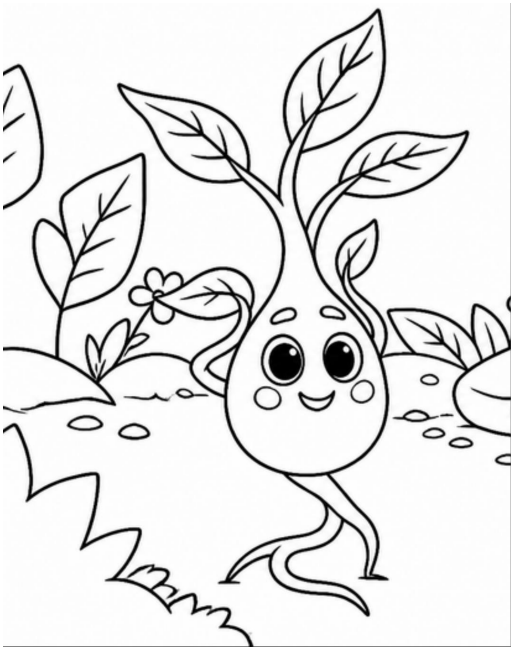
something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Grow a bean

10 minutes, then a few minutes daily for two weeks, Individual, Materials: Bean seeds, clear cups, damp paper towels, a sunny window

Put a damp paper towel inside a clear cup and slide a bean between the towel and the cup so you can see it. Keep it damp. Check every day and draw what you see: the root going down, the shoot going up. Say the worm's words when nothing seems to happen.

Be the seed

5 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Quiet music (optional)

Curl up small like a seed. The teacher is the rain (wiggle fingers) and the sun (open arms). Slowly, slowly, push up one hand like a shoot, then stand and stretch into a tall tree.

Growing chart

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A long paper strip

Make a chart of things children are getting better at little by little. Come back to it in a month and add what has grown.

Science and nature corner

Oak trees grow from acorns. When an acorn has enough water and warmth, it sends a root down into the soil first, then a shoot pushes up toward the light. Young trees grow slowly and some take many years to make their own acorns. Worms help plants by mixing and loosening the soil. Deer eat leaves and young plants: that's just how they find food.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. What did Oakie want more than anything at the start?

Look for: To see the light and feel the wind.

2. How do you think Oakie felt when he pushed and nothing happened?

Look for: Frustrated or impatient. Accept any feeling word.

3. Why did Oakie decide to keep growing after the deer nibbled his leaf?

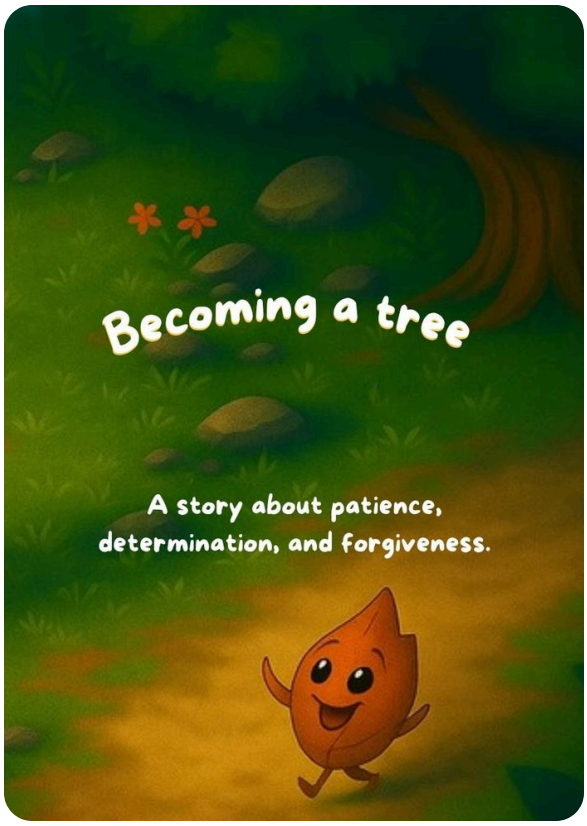
Look for: He felt that life in the light was worth it.

4. What are you waiting for, or getting better at, little by little?

Look for: Any answer: reading, swimming, a birthday, a tooth.

5. What would you tell a little seed who wants to grow up fast?

Look for: Be patient, keep trying, good things take time.



Say it together

Good things take time.

The big idea: Some things can't be hurried. If you keep trying and wait, you grow when you are ready.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show patience this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show patience by

Name _____



I can show patience by

Name _____



I can show patience by

Name _____



I can show patience by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Problem Solving and Innovating	Belonging and Contributing	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's forest has no name, so we picked Shenandoah National Park, in the Blue Ridge Mountains. Its woods are mostly oak and hickory, and deer are everywhere.



Earthworm

A huge earthworm found in South Africa in 1967 was 6.7 metres long!



Song sparrow

A song sparrow's heart beats about 450 times a minute.



White-tailed deer

A white-tailed deer can leap 3 metres high and 9 metres in one bound.



American red squirrel

Its loud chatter warns other squirrels to stay away.



Eastern bluebird

All the eggs from one mother bluebird are the same colour.

Shenandoah National Park, Virginia

The kind worm: The book's worm is green and striped. Real earthworms are usually pink, brown or reddish, but they really do live right next to seeds in the soil.

The passing bird: The book doesn't name the passing bird, so we picked the song sparrow, a common brown bird of North America. It really does sing about everything!

The hungry deer: Real deer do love to nibble young plants and leaves, so a hungry deer and a little sprout is very true to life!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/becoming-a-tree

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Use the bean cups to show seed, root and sprout. Sound words (plip-plop, shine-shine) are easy to join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 4, 8 and 11). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children measure their bean every day and make a simple bar chart of how it grows.

Handle with care

Patience is not sitting still and being quiet. Oakie keeps trying the whole time.

Some beans won't sprout. Plant a few extras so every child has something to watch, and treat a seed that doesn't grow kindly.

The deer is not bad; deer eat plants. Oakie forgives it, and that is a small, gentle moment in the story.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn't come from one culture. Many traditions compare people to trees and seeds: growing slowly, little by little, and passing on what they have learned to those who come next.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read Becoming a Tree, a story about patience. Oakie the seed wants to grow right now, but learns from a kind worm that good things take time, and he grows into a strong tree. At home, plant a seed together, like a bean in a cup, and check it each day. When nothing seems to happen, say together: 'Good things take time.' You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Devenir un arbre, une histoire sur la patience. Oakie la graine veut grandir tout de suite, mais un gentil ver de terre lui apprend que les belles choses demandent du temps, et il devient un arbre solide. À la maison, plantez ensemble une graine, comme un haricot dans un gobelet, et regardez-la chaque jour. Quand rien ne semble se passer, dites ensemble : « Les belles choses demandent du temps. » Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



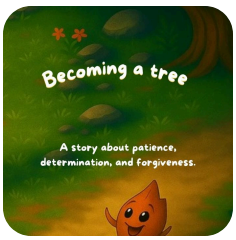
Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre la paciencia. Oakie, la semilla, quiere crecer ya, pero aprende de un gusano amable que las cosas buenas toman tiempo, y se convierte en un árbol fuerte. En casa, planten juntos una semilla, como un frijol en un vaso, y mírenla cada día. Cuando parezca que no pasa nada, digan juntos: «Las cosas buenas toman tiempo». Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über Geduld gelesen. Der kleine Samen Oakie will sofort wachsen, lernt aber von einem freundlichen Regenwurm, dass gute Dinge Zeit brauchen, und wird zu einem starken Baum. Pflanzen Sie zu Hause gemeinsam einen Samen, etwa eine Bohne in einem Becher, und schauen Sie jeden Tag nach. Wenn scheinbar nichts passiert, sagen Sie zusammen: ‚Gute Dinge brauchen Zeit.' Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sulla pazienza. Oakie, il semino, vuole crescere subito, ma un lombrico gentile gli insegna che le cose belle richiedono tempo, e diventa un albero forte. A casa, piantate insieme un seme, come un fagiolo in un bicchiere, e guardatelo ogni giorno. Quando sembra che non succeda niente, dite insieme: «Le cose belle richiedono tempo». Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Patience: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Patience: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Patience: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Patience: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Becoming a Tree

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: patience.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Some things can't be hurried. If you keep trying and wait, you grow when you are ready.

Say it together

Good things take time.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
seed	a tiny thing that a plant grows from	pinch your fingers into a tiny dot
soil	the earth that plants grow in	rub your fingers together like crumbly dirt
root	the part of a plant that grows down into the ground	wiggle your fingers downward
sprout	a new little plant pushing up	push one hand slowly up through the other
patient	able to wait calmly	fold your hands and breathe

A gentle note

Patience is not sitting still and being quiet. Oakie keeps trying the whole time.

Some beans won't sprout. Plant a few extras so every child has something to watch, and treat a seed that doesn't grow kindly.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



The kind worm

Earthworm

Tells Oakie to be patient



The passing bird

Song sparrow

Tells Oakie about sunlight and wind



The hungry deer

White-tailed deer

Nibbles Oakie's leaves, and is later forgiven



The squirrel

American red squirrel

Lives in the grown-up tree



The little blue bird

Eastern bluebird

Visits Oakie when he's a tree

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How did they feel?

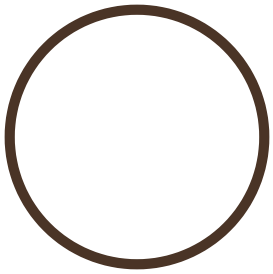
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Oakie lies in the dark soil.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

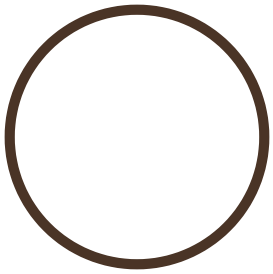


Moment 2

A root goes down and a shoot goes up.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

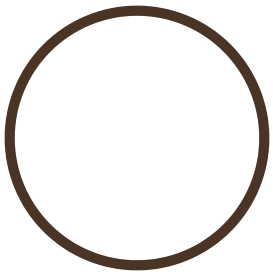


Moment 3

Oakie gives the little seed the worm's advice.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

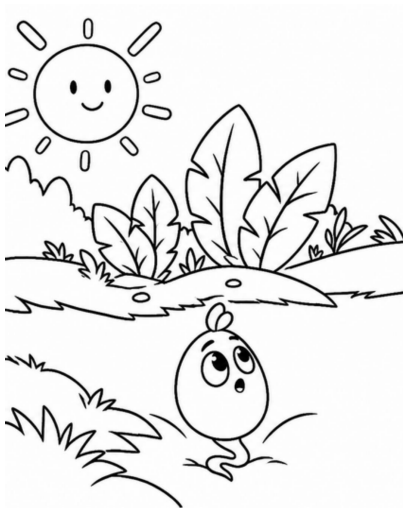
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

seed a tiny thing that a plant grows from

seed seed

soil the earth that plants grow in

soil soil

root the part of a plant that grows down into the ground

root root

Oakie the hero of the story

Oakie Oakie

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Oakie showed patience. Draw a time when you showed patience too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Grow a bean

You need: Bean seeds, clear cups, damp paper towels, a sunny window

Put a damp paper towel inside a clear cup and slide a bean between the towel and the cup so you can see it. Keep it damp. Check every day and draw what you see: the root going down, the shoot going up. Say the worm's words when nothing seems to happen.

Plant a seed

Plant a bean in a cup of soil. Water it and watch it grow. How many days until you see a sprout?

Patience timer

Set a timer for one minute and sit very still, like a seed waiting underground. How did it feel?

Acorn hunt

In autumn, look for acorns under oak trees. Can you find one with its little cap?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Becoming a Tree are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



The kind worm

Earthworm

A huge earthworm found in South Africa in 1967 was 6.7 metres long!



The passing bird

Song sparrow

A song sparrow's heart beats about 450 times a minute.



The hungry deer

White-tailed deer

A white-tailed deer can leap 3 metres high and 9 metres in one bound.



The squirrel

American red squirrel

Its loud chatter warns other squirrels to stay away.

Story or real?

The book's worm is green and striped. Real earthworms are usually pink, brown or reddish, but they really do live right next to seeds in the soil.

Where they really live

The book's forest has no name, so we picked Shenandoah National Park, in the Blue Ridge Mountains. Its woods are mostly oak and hickory, and deer are everywhere.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/becoming-a-tree

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What do you think this story is about? How do trees start?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 1

What did Oakie want more than anything at the start?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 2

How do you think Oakie felt when he pushed and nothing happened?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 3

Why did Oakie decide to keep growing after the deer nibbled his leaf?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 4

What are you waiting for, or getting better at, little by little?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 5

What would you tell a little seed who wants to grow up fast?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 6

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Patience hero

This is to say that

_____

showed patience, just like Oakie.

Good things take time.

Signed _____ Date _____